Nobody has said this up to now, yet that is the impression one gets. In this context, it seems to me that Secretary of State Antony Blinken's warnings are of much greater significance for Israeli military goals than Nasrallah's bluster. The US is flying MQ-9 drones over Gaza to help Israel locate the hostages.

Israel can nonetheless count on the United States in the face of the international anti-Israel coalition that is taking shape. For the time being, this coalition is essentially active in the propaganda domain and the transfer of some weapons systems to Hamas. Apart from Iran, which is fully engaged against the "Zionist entity," the participants are Iran's ally, Russia (since the Ukraine war) and, increasingly, China. These three powers are united in a global confrontation with the US. This is the fundamental reason for American support of Israel in the present conflict.

As if all this weren't enough, Israel has leaked a position paper formulated by Military Intelligence proposing the transfer of the Palestinian population from Gaza to northern Sinai—an idiotic idea that has caused an outcry in Egypt and from all possible international aid agencies. It shows that nobody knows what a safe postwar solution could be.

Israel's proclamations about the long fight to come may have been disinformation, as later news indicates some panic in Hamas's ranks. The organization attempted to smuggle its people among the American citizens who were allowed to depart through the Rafah crossing to Egypt. The Al-Shifa Hospital is apparently encircled.

Saturday, November 4

Demonstrations against Netanyahu resumed in Jerusalem, Caesarea, and other small cities. People who lost family members on October 7, or whose family members were taken hostage on that day, consider him responsible.